SELF-ESTEEM IMAGERY SCRIPT — FLIP THEORY: YOU BUILD IT BY DOING IT

TM-002 (T.M., 22, 69% Emotional) | Standalone therapeutic recording script | Emotional lane: permissive, imagery-rich, inferential | ~25 min in trance | Connects to existing anchors (tribe circle, thumb+forefinger) | **THERAPIST VERBATIM**

CORE FLIP: Self-esteem is not something you receive. It is something you BUILD through esteemable acts. The old model says "feel worthy, then act worthy." The flip says "act worthy, and the feeling of worth follows." Self-efficacy (I CAN do) + Self-worth (I AM valuable) = Self-esteem. Both are EARNED through behavior, not granted by others. This script installs that flip at a subconscious level through imagery.

TM-002 SPECIFIC: His self-esteem attack pattern: judges someone → feels guilty about the judgment → labels himself ("asshole," "judgmental") → shame → lower self-esteem. The flip reframes: the judgment was a momentary reaction (weather), not identity (sky). The LABEL is the damage vector, not the thought itself. Install: "notice the thought, release the label, choose the esteemable act."

SECTION 1: INDUCTION BRIDGE (FROM EXISTING TRANCE OR STANDALONE) ~2 MIN

If used mid-session after Circle Therapy: skip induction, bridge directly from trance. If standalone recording: use standard induction (breathing, affirmations, Deep Sleep, 5-0, staircase) then enter here.

In this deep state of relaxation, I want to take you somewhere new. Not the circle tonight. Not the staircase. Somewhere you have never been. A place your subconscious is about to build for you.

... 5 sec ...

Picture yourself standing in a large, open workshop. Not a factory. Not an office. A craftsman's workshop. **Yours.** The kind of space where things are built by hand. Where raw materials become something real.

The floor is warm wood. The light is natural — coming through tall windows. There are workbenches. Tools. Materials. Everything organized. Everything waiting. This is the place where your self-esteem is built. Not given. Not inherited. Not downloaded from someone else's opinion. **Built. By you. With your own hands.**

... 7 sec ...

SECTION 2: THE FLIP — SELF-ESTEEM IS BUILT, NOT GIVEN ~4 MIN

There is something most people get wrong about self-esteem. They think it works like this: first you feel worthy, then you act worthy. First the confidence arrives, then you do the brave thing. First you believe in yourself, then you show up.

That is backwards.

... 5 sec ...

Here is the truth that your subconscious already knows: **self-esteem is not a feeling that arrives. It is a structure you build.** You build it through action. Through esteemable acts. Acts that are worthy of respect. Conducted with integrity, with care, with responsibility toward yourself and toward others.

You do not wait until you feel confident to act with confidence. You act with integrity — and the confidence forms around the action like muscle forms around bone. The doing comes first. The feeling follows. **Always.**

... 5 sec ...

Self-esteem rests on two pillars. The first is **self-efficacy** — the knowledge, deep in your body, that you can think, decide, and act. That you can handle what life puts in front of you. That you have navigated hard things before and you will navigate hard things again. Not perfectly. But capably. Adequately. Enough.

The second pillar is **self-worth** — the core belief that you are inherently valuable. Not because someone told you so. Not because you earned a title or won an approval. Because your existence, your presence, your being — has value. Intrinsic. Unconditional. Not negotiable.

Both of these pillars are **built**. Brick by brick. Act by act. Decision by decision. And right now, in this workshop of yours, you are going to see how.

... 7 sec ...

Look around the workshop. There are five workbenches. Each one represents a category of esteemable behavior. Each one builds a different part of the structure. And together, they create something unshakeable.

... 5 sec ...

The first workbench: Showing Up for Yourself.

Walk over to it. On this bench are the raw materials of self-care and self-commitment. A calendar with commitments you made to yourself — and kept. A pair of running shoes, worn. A journal, filled. A meal you cooked because your body deserved real food, not just whatever was fastest.

Every time you make a commitment to yourself and follow through — exercising when you said you would, eating something that nourishes you, meditating even for five minutes, listening genuinely when someone talks to you — you lay a brick. A real brick. In the wall of self-efficacy. I said I would, and I did. That is a brick. And no one can take it away.

Pick up a brick from this bench. Feel the weight of it. Solid. Real. Earned. Place it on the foundation in the center of the workshop. That is yours.

... 7 sec ...

The second workbench: Service to Others.

On this bench are the tools of contribution. A hand extended to someone who needed help. Time given freely. Energy spent on something bigger than yourself. Mentoring. Volunteering. Showing up for someone when it would have been easier not to.

You know what it feels like to help someone, Tristan. You pulled your friend from the river. You did not think about it. You just acted. And something inside you — something real, something earned — shifted. That was not confidence given to you. That was confidence built in the moment of the act. The rescuer in you is not a label. It is evidence. Evidence of who you become when it matters.

Pick up a brick from this bench. Feel it. It is warm. Because it carries the heat of genuine connection. Place it on the foundation. Another brick. Yours.

... 7 sec ...

The third workbench: Cultivating Your Surroundings.

On this bench are the blueprints of your environment. The spaces you choose to inhabit. The media you choose to consume. The people you choose to spend time with. The physical spaces you organize or let fall into chaos.

When you clean your room, you are not just cleaning a room. You are telling your subconscious: I deserve order. I deserve a space that reflects my value. When you choose to step away from content that makes you feel worse about yourself, you are building a wall — not of defense, but of curation. You are the architect of what enters your world.

Pick up this brick. It is lighter than the others. Because cultivation is not heavy labor. It is a series of small, quiet decisions that compound. Place it on the foundation.

... 5 sec ...

The fourth workbench: Authentic Expression.

On this bench is a mirror. Not the kind that shows you what others want to see. The kind that shows you who you actually are. And beside it: the clothes you wear, the words you choose, the way you carry yourself — not to perform. Not to please. But because they feel honest. Comfortable. Yours.

Every time you express something real instead of something calculated to manage someone else's perception of you, you earn a brick. Every time you dress in a way that feels like you instead of like camouflage, you earn a brick. Authenticity is not reckless honesty. It is the steady practice of being who you are in a world that constantly asks you to be someone else.

Pick up this brick. Notice — it is the most uniquely shaped of all of them. No two are alike. Because authenticity cannot be mass-produced. Place it on the foundation.

... 5 sec ...

The fifth workbench: Personal Accountability.

This is the heaviest bench. The most important. On it are the tools of integrity. Doing the right thing when no one is watching. Standing up for your boundaries when it would be easier to fold. Accepting responsibility for your choices — not with shame, but with ownership. **I did that. I chose that. And I can choose differently next time.**

This is where the old pattern breaks, Tristan. The old pattern said: **I had a judgmental thought, therefore I am a bad person.** That is not accountability. That is self-punishment disguised as accountability. Real accountability says: **I noticed a judgmental thought. It was a reaction to a specific situation. It does not define me. And my next action — the esteemable act I choose next — is what actually builds my worth.**

The thought is weather. The label is damage. The **act** is the brick.

... 7 sec ...

Pick up this brick. It is the heaviest. Because accountability costs something. It requires looking at yourself honestly and choosing growth over comfort. Place it on the foundation. Feel the weight settle. Feel the structure hold.

... 7 sec ...

Five workbenches. Five categories. Five bricks on the foundation. And the structure is already taking shape. Not because someone handed it to you. Because **you walked to each bench and you picked up each brick and you placed it yourself.** That is the flip. That is how self-esteem actually works.

PHS: "For the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, safely and comfortably, this understanding settles deep into the subconscious mind. Self-esteem is built. Through esteemable acts. Through action. Through choice. Brick by brick."

SECTION 4: THE SELF-TALK REWRITE — THE CRITIC BECOMES THE COACH ~5 MIN

Now. In this workshop, there is one more thing. In the corner. A machine. Old. Dusty. It has been running for a long time. Automatically. Without your permission.

It is a printing press. And it prints one thing: **labels.**

"Asshole." "Judgmental." "Not good enough." "Failure." It prints them fast. And every time one comes off the press, it tries to stick itself to your skin. To become part of your identity. And for years, you let it. Because you thought the press was telling the truth. You thought the labels were facts.

... 5 sec ...

They are not facts. They are cognitive distortions. Faulty logic. Old programming. And tonight, you are going to rewrite the code.

Walk over to the press. Look at the labels it is printing right now. Pick one up. Read it. Whatever it says — the harshest thing your inner voice tells you regularly — hold it up to the light.

... 10 sec ...

> **Step one: identify.** You caught it. You see the label. You see the exact thought. That is already more than most people ever do. Most people wear the labels without ever reading them. You just read yours.
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> **Step two: name the trick.** The press uses three main tricks. All-or-nothing thinking: **"If I am not perfect, I am a failure."** That is black and white in a world made of color. Catastrophizing: **"One bad moment means everything is ruined."** That is a weather report that predicts hurricanes from a single cloud. Mind reading: **"Everyone thinks I am terrible."** That is writing someone else's script without asking them. Which trick is your label using?
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> ... 7 sec ...
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> **Step three: fact-check.** Hold the label up. Ask it one question: **"Is this an objective fact, or is this an emotional reaction to a specific moment?"** If you called yourself an asshole for having a judgmental thought about a rude customer — is "asshole" a factual description of who you are across all contexts of your entire life? Or is it a reaction to one thought in one moment? You already know the answer.
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> **Step four: replace.** Take the label. Turn it over. And on the back, write the balanced truth. Not toxic positivity. Not denial. The fair, realistic, compassionate statement. The one a good coach would say. The one the rescuer in you would say to someone else in your position.
>
> **"I had a critical thought about someone. That was a reaction, not my identity. I have also helped people, shown courage, and acted with genuine care. One thought in one moment does not erase a lifetime of evidence. And my next act — the esteemable act I choose right now — adds another brick."**

... 7 sec ...

Now look at the printing press. You have a choice. You cannot destroy it — the mind will always generate thoughts, including harsh ones. But you can do something better. **You can change what it prints.**

Reach behind the press. There is a dial. The old setting says **CRITIC**. Turn it. Slowly. Feel the resistance — years of habit pushing back. Turn it until it clicks to a new setting: **COACH**.

... 5 sec ...

The press hums. It still runs. It still prints. But now what comes off the line is different. Not labels. **Observations.** Not judgments. **Noticing.** Not "you are an asshole." Instead: **"You had a reaction. It was human. What is your next move?"**

The coach does not lie to you. It does not tell you everything is fine when it is not. It tells you the truth **without attaching it to your identity.** That is the difference between a critic and a coach. The critic says "you ARE a failure." The coach says "that attempt failed. Here is what you can do next."

PHS: "For the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, the dial is turned. The inner voice shifts from critic to coach. Thoughts still come. Labels no longer stick. Because you read them. You fact-check them. And you replace them with the balanced truth. Automatically. Naturally. Each time faster than the last."

SECTION 5: THE TWO GAUGES — SELF-EFFICACY + SELF-WORTH ~3 MIN

On the wall of your workshop, above the foundation you have been building, there are two gauges. Like fuel gauges. Analog. Honest. They do not lie and they do not flatter.

> The gauge on the left reads **SELF-EFFICACY**. It measures your lived confidence. Not the confidence someone told you to feel. The confidence that comes from evidence. From having done hard things. From having survived things you thought would break you. From having shown up when it mattered.
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> Look at the needle. It is not at zero. It has never been at zero. Because you have done things. Real things. You pulled someone from a river. You showed up for therapy when it would have been easier to stay home. You sat in the circle last session and you faced your triggers. Every one of those acts moved this needle. The needle does not lie. It reads what you have actually done.
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> … 5 sec …
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> The gauge on the right reads **SELF-WORTH**. It measures something deeper. Not what you can do. What you **are.** And here is what the gauge knows that the critic never told you: your worth is not determined by your worst thought. Your worth is not the average of your mistakes. Your worth exists independent of performance. It was there before you achieved anything. It will be there after any failure.
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> But — and this is the flip — you **feel** your worth most clearly when you act in alignment with it. When you perform esteemable acts, the gauge does not create worth. It **reveals** the worth that was always there. Like wiping fog from a mirror. The reflection was always there. You just could not see it.

Both gauges are moving. Right now. With every brick you placed. With the dial you turned. With every act of integrity, care, accountability, and authenticity you will perform between now and next session. The needles rise. Not because someone praised you. Because **you earned it.**

PHS: "For the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, these two gauges are installed. Self-efficacy and self-worth. They read honestly. They respond to esteemable acts. And each act — no matter how small — moves the needle. Permanently."

SECTION 6: OLD PATTERN VS. NEW PATTERN ~3 MIN

Before we leave this workshop, I want you to see two versions of tomorrow. Side by side. Like two screens.

> **On the left screen: the old pattern.** Something goes wrong. A harsh thought fires. The critic labels you. You accept the label without question. You shrink. You second-guess. You compare yourself to someone else's highlight reel. You say yes when you mean no, because saying no feels selfish. You deflect a compliment because accepting it feels fraudulent. And at the end of the day, the gauges drop. Not because you failed. Because you let the labels stick.
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> … 5 sec …
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> **On the right screen: the new pattern.** Something goes wrong. A harsh thought fires — same as before. The thought is the same. But this time, you catch it. You read the label. You name the trick. You fact-check. You replace it with the balanced truth. And then — here is the part that changes everything — **you choose the next esteemable act.**
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> You hold a boundary. Brick. You show up for something you committed to. Brick. You express something authentic instead of something safe. Brick. You accept a compliment with a simple "thank you" and feel the genuine pride underneath it. Brick. You measure your progress against your own past self — not against someone else's edited version of their life. Brick.
>
> And at the end of the day, the gauges rise. Not because the day was perfect. Because **you built something with it.**

… 7 sec …

Which screen do you want tomorrow to look like?

… 10 sec …

Your subconscious already knows. The right screen. The workshop. The bricks. The coach instead of the critic. The gauges rising because of what you DO, not what others think. **That is the flip. And it is already running.**

SECTION 7: ANCHOR INTEGRATION + POST-HYPNOTIC SUGGESTIONS ~3 MIN

> Press your thumb and forefinger together. Right hand.
>
> … 3 sec …
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> Feel the tribe. The circle. The armor. And now — the workshop. The five workbenches. The bricks. The gauges. The coach. All of it. Layered into one gesture. One breath.
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> From this moment forward, when you press thumb and forefinger together, you do not just feel protection. You feel **capability.** You do not just feel the tribe around you. You feel the builder in you. The one who lays bricks. The one who earns his own esteem. The one who turns the dial from critic to coach.

… 5 sec …

Between now and our next session, you will notice something. When a harsh thought fires — and it will, because the mind generates thoughts — you will catch it faster. Not in minutes. In seconds. The label will try to stick and something in you will say: **"Wait. Read it first."** And you will read it. And you will fact-check it. And you will replace it. Not because I told you to. Because the coach is running now.

You will also notice something else. Small acts will feel different. Making your bed. Eating something real. Holding a boundary. Helping someone. These will register differently. Not as chores. As **bricks.** And each one will move the needle. And you will feel it. A quiet sense of earned pride. Not arrogance. Not performance. **Evidence.** Evidence that you are building something real.

And one more thing. When someone offers you a compliment — genuine recognition of something you did — you will notice the old impulse to deflect. And this time, you will let it pass. You will accept it with a simple "thank you." Not because you need their approval. Because you know the brick is real. And their recognition is just confirmation of what the gauge already shows.

PHS: "For the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, safely and comfortably: the workshop is built. The gauges are installed. The coach is running. Esteemable acts build self-esteem. The flip is permanent. And it grows stronger with each act, each day, each brick. Sealed. Protected. Yours."

SECTION 8: SEAL + EMERGENCE ~2 MIN

If mid-session: bridge back to main session flow (count out or next segment). If standalone recording: use standard count out below.

Before we return, seal everything. Every brick. Every workbench. Every gauge. The coach. The balanced truth. The flip. All of it. Sealed into the subconscious mind. Growing. Compounding. Every esteemable act from this day forward adds to the structure. And the structure does not decay. It only builds.

The workshop is always there. You can return to it anytime. In meditation. Before sleep. When you need to remind yourself how self-esteem actually works. Not from the outside in. From the inside out. Not from praise. From action. Not from labels. From bricks.

… 5 sec …

Zero. Close the door to the subconscious. Seal in every positive suggestion. Block all negatives. Only the positive enters. Only the positive remains.

One. Feel your body. The surface beneath you. Your feet. The temperature of the room.

Two. Fingers move. Toes wiggle. A stretch if your body wants it.

Three. Halfway back. Refreshed. Rested. Clear-headed. Carrying something new. Something built.

Four. More alert. Sounds around you. Light beyond your eyelids. The workshop is sealed. The gauges are running.

Five. Eyes open. Wide awake. Fully alert. Welcome back.

THERAPIST NOTES

REFERENCE

Imagery architecture: *Workshop = self-esteem construction site. 5 workbenches = 5 categories of esteemable behavior. Bricks = individual acts. Foundation = cumulative self-esteem structure. Printing press = automatic self-talk. Dial (CRITIC → COACH) = CBT reframe installed at subconscious level. Two gauges = self-efficacy + self-worth. Two screens = old pattern vs new pattern (future pace).*

Flip theory installed: *"Act worthy → feel worthy" replaces "feel worthy → act worthy." Self-esteem as VERB (building) not NOUN (possession). Earned through behavior, not received through validation.*

TM-002 specific hooks: *River rescue = evidence of self-efficacy brick. Self-labeling loop = the printing press. "Weather vs sky" callback from S2a. Rescuer-helper identity = workbench 2. Tribe circle + anchor = compounded with workshop.*

CBT 4-step rewrite embedded: *(1) Identify = read the label, (2) Label distortion = name the trick (all-or-nothing, catastrophizing, mind reading), (3) Fact-check = "objective fact or emotional reaction?", (4) Replace = balanced truth on the back of the label.*

Post-hypnotic triggers: *Catch harsh thoughts faster (seconds not minutes). Small acts register as bricks. Compliments accepted with "thank you." Anchor now includes workshop/builder/coach alongside tribe/circle/armor.*

Use cases: *(1) Standalone recording for between-session listening. (2) Mid-session insert after Circle Therapy Phase 14 (before count out). (3) Session 4+ primary therapeutic work if self-esteem emerges as next priority after fear extinction.*